

# LENDING A HELPING HAND

While start-ups are buffeted by headwinds, GetVantage's proposition of revenue-based financing is helping many of them survive the storm **By Ashish Rukhaiyar**

**IT ALL STARTED** when Bhavik Vasa heard about deals where founders were bartering stakes in their companies with media firms in exchange for ads and promotions on their platforms. "While scaling operations and visibility for ItzCash (acquired by Ebix in 2017 and renamed EbixCash), I came across the 'ad for equity model', a barter deal where media houses take a certain stake in companies in return for ads and promotions on their platform," says Vasa, Founder and CEO of GetVantage. "When I quit EbixCash to go on a personal break, the thought of providing alternative financing to start-ups for plans that would directly impact and improve their bottom line kept lingering," he adds.

42 | Thus was born GetVantage in 2019, which is today a prominent revenue-based financing (RBF) platform that has funded more than 650 ventures. Its cumulative gross merchandise value (GMV) of funding stands at over \$700 million. Simply put, RBF refers to a mechanism where a start-up can

avail growth funding without the founders having to dilute any stake or offer any collateral.

In GetVantage's case, both Vasa (39) and Co-founder and CTO Amit Srivastava (42) come from a start-up background. While Vasa was a mentor and advisor for fintech cohorts at Startupbootcamp, Srivastava was the CTO of the accelerator before they started building GetVantage. What has really helped them scale GetVantage is that they are not programmed to think like



## GETVANTAGE

- **BHAVIK VASA (right), FOUNDER & CEO**
- **AMIT SRIVASTAVA, CO-FOUNDER & CTO**

### KEY INVESTORS

Chiratae Ventures, Dream Incubator Japan, Varanium Group, DMI Sparkle Fund, InCred, Sony Innovation Fund

### FUNDING

\$41 million in equity and credit lines across two rounds; next fundraising planned in 2024

### FINANCIALS

It had revenues of ₹11.2 crore and net losses of ₹7.7 crore in FY23, compared to ₹5.8 crore in revenues and ₹3 crore in net losses in FY22, per Tracxn

### WHAT MAKES IT COOL

It helps start-ups raise funds without equity dilution, collateral or guaranties

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